AED



Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: AED (Automated External defibrillator)

What it is used for

An Automated External Defibrillator (AED) analyses a person's heart rhythm and, when indicated, advises or delivers an electric shock to help treat certain cardiac arrests. Use it promptly with CPR according to the device prompts and local emergency procedures.

Main parts

- AED unit and display or voice prompts
- Electrode pads and connecting cable
- Battery or power module
- Shock button on semi-automatic models
- Protective case and quick-reference instructions
- Optional child pads or paediatric mode, depending on model

Before you start

1. Confirm that the scene is safe for the rescuer and patient.
2. Check responsiveness and normal breathing; if the person is unresponsive and not breathing normally, call emergency services and request an AED.
3. Ask another person to bring the AED and begin CPR immediately if indicated.
4. Turn on the AED and follow its voice or visual prompts.
5. Expose the patient's chest and dry it if wet; remove medication patches from pad sites using gloves and wipe the skin clean.
6. Check for implanted medical devices or jewellery under pad positions and place pads as directed by the AED instructions.

How to use

1. Open the AED case, turn on the unit, and follow every voice or screen instruction.
2. Attach the pads to the bare chest in the positions shown on the pad illustrations.
3. Connect the pad cable if it is not already attached.
4. Ensure nobody touches the patient while the AED analyses the heart rhythm.
5. If a shock is advised, loudly tell everyone to stand clear and visually confirm that nobody is touching the patient.
6. Press the flashing shock button when instructed on a semi-automatic AED; a fully automatic AED may deliver the shock itself.
7. Immediately resume CPR when prompted, starting with chest compressions, and follow the AED's instructions for the next analysis.

8. Continue CPR and AED-guided care until the person shows signs of life, trained responders take over, the scene becomes unsafe, or you are physically unable to continue.
9. If no shock is advised, immediately resume CPR as directed; do not delay care.
10. When emergency responders arrive, report the time of collapse if known, CPR performed, and any shocks delivered.
11. After use, arrange replacement pads and battery as needed, clean the device according to the manufacturer's instructions, and report the use.

⚠ Safety

- Use the AED as soon as available for a suspected cardiac arrest and follow its prompts.
- Do not touch the patient during rhythm analysis or shock delivery.
- Keep the patient and chest dry; do not use the AED in standing water or an unsafe environment.
- Do not place pads directly over medication patches or implanted device bulges; follow pad-placement instructions.
- Use paediatric pads or mode for children when available and indicated; follow the AED instructions if these are unavailable.
- Do not delay CPR while waiting for an AED or emergency responders.

Care & storage

- Check the readiness indicator and battery status at the schedule specified by the manufacturer.
- Inspect pad packaging and expiry dates regularly and replace used, expired, or damaged pads.
- Keep the AED and accessories in their designated, accessible storage location.
- After use, restore the device to ready status and document checks or faults.
- Arrange service promptly if the AED shows an error or fails its self-test.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Waiting for the AED instead of starting CPR when indicated.
- Failing to ensure everyone is clear during analysis or shock delivery.
- Placing pads over clothing or without adequate skin contact.
- Stopping CPR for too long or ignoring the device prompts.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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